

gymbro

Install Guide

Get the workout tracker onto your own iPhone —
written for complete beginners. Every click is spelled out.

Repository:

<https://github.com/gagangeet2517-arch/gymbro>

Free to install with any Apple ID · no programming knowledge needed

1. What is gymbro, and what are we about to do?

gymbro is a personal workout and nutrition tracker: log workouts from ready-made plans, snap photos of meals to count calories with AI, speak your sets out loud, and watch your strength grow on charts. Everything stays on your phone — no account, no cloud.

Because gymbro is not on the App Store, you install it yourself using a Mac. Don't worry if you have never done anything like this: this guide assumes zero experience and walks through every single click. The one-time setup takes about an hour (mostly waiting for downloads). After that, keeping the app running takes two minutes a week.

Note: Only have a Windows PC, or don't want to touch any of this? Sections 1–9 need a Mac — Xcode (the tool that does the installing) only exists for macOS, there is no Windows version, ever. Read **SETUP-WINDOWS.pdf** (also in github.com/gagangeet2517-arch/gymbro) instead — it covers installing gymbro via AltStore, which needs no Mac and no Xcode at all.

2. What you need

This section (and 3–9) is the Mac path. If you're on Windows or just want gymbro without touching Xcode, read **SETUP-WINDOWS.pdf** instead.

- **A Mac** (any reasonably recent MacBook or iMac) — required for this path; read **SETUP-WINDOWS.pdf** if you don't have one.
- **Your iPhone** and its **charging cable** (it must connect to the Mac).
- **An Apple ID** — the normal, free one you already use for the App Store.
- **About 15 GB of free disk space** on the Mac (the Apple developer tools are big).
- About **an hour**, most of it waiting for downloads.

Note: You do NOT need: a paid developer account, programming knowledge, or an Android phone (this guide is iPhone-only).

3. Sixty seconds of background (worth reading)

3.1 What is "Terminal"?

Terminal is an app that comes with every Mac. Instead of clicking buttons, you type a line of text and press **Enter** (Return), and the Mac carries out that instruction. That's the whole idea. You type a line — exactly as written in this guide — press Enter, and wait until new text stops appearing and you see the blinking cursor again. Then you type the next line.

To open it: press **■ (Command) + Spacebar**, type **terminal**, press Enter.

3.2 What does "cd" mean?

Terminal is always "standing inside" one folder, and commands act on that folder. `cd` (change directory) is how you walk into a folder. So `cd ~/Desktop/gymbro-main` means: "go into the gymbro-main folder on my Desktop". A trick that avoids typos: type `cd` (with a space), then drag the folder from Finder into the Terminal window — the path fills itself in — then press Enter.

3.3 What are Xcode, Node, and the rest?

- **Xcode** — Apple's free app for building iPhone apps. We use it to sign and install gymbro.
- **Node.js** — a free program that runs the app's build tools.
- **Homebrew & CocoaPods** — two small helper tools the build needs. Installed with one pasted line each.

4. One-time: install the tools (≈45 min, mostly waiting)

4.1 Install Xcode

Note: On Windows? Stop here — Xcode is Mac-only and there is no way to install it on Windows. Read [SETUP-WINDOWS.pdf](#) instead.

- 1 Open the **App Store** app on the Mac.
- 2 Search for **Xcode**, click **Get**, then **Install**. It is a very large download (often 30–60 minutes) — start it and move on to step 4.2 while it downloads.
- 3 When it finishes, **open Xcode once**. Click **Agree** on the licence, let it "install components" if it asks, then you can close it.

4.2 Install Node.js

- 1 In a web browser, go to nodejs.org.
- 2 Click the big green **LTS** download button (the version number doesn't matter).
- 3 Open the downloaded .pkg file and click **Continue** → **Continue** → **Agree** → **Install**. Enter your Mac password when asked.

4.3 Install Homebrew, then CocoaPods

Open Terminal (⌘+Space → "terminal" → Enter). Copy-paste this whole line, press Enter, type your Mac password when asked (the password stays invisible while you type — that's normal), and follow any "press RETURN to continue" prompts:

```
/bin/bash -c "$(curl -fsSL https://raw.githubusercontent.com/Homebrew/install/HEAD/install.sh)"
```

When Homebrew finishes it may print a box saying **"Next steps"** with two commands to run — copy-paste those two lines too (they connect Homebrew to your Terminal). Then install CocoaPods:

```
brew install cocoapods
```

Note: If a command replies "command not found: brew", you skipped the "Next steps" lines above — scroll up in Terminal, find them, and run them. Then close Terminal, reopen it, and try again.

5. Get the app's code (2 minutes)

The easiest way — no extra tools needed:

- 1 In a browser, go to <https://github.com/gagangeet2517-arch/gymbro>.
- 2 Click the green <> **Code** button, then **Download ZIP**.

- 3 Open your **Downloads** folder and double-click `gymbro-main.zip` — it unzips into a folder called **gymbro-main**.
- 4 Drag the **gymbro-main** folder onto your **Desktop**.

Note: That folder IS the app. Don't rename it or move things around inside it. (If a techie friend set you up with "git clone" instead, your folder is called **gymbro**, not `gymbro-main` — use that name in the commands below.)

6. Prepare the project (10 minutes, two commands)

In Terminal, go into the app folder:

```
cd ~/Desktop/gymbro-main
```

Now run these two commands, **one at a time**, waiting for each to finish. The first downloads the app's building blocks (2–5 minutes, prints a lot of text — warnings are normal). The second generates the iPhone project (a few more minutes):

```
npm install  
npx expo prebuild -p ios
```

You're done when the cursor is blinking again with no error in red. A new **ios** folder now exists inside `gymbro-main`.

7. Connect your Apple ID (5 minutes, one time)

Apple requires every iPhone app to be "signed" by someone. You'll sign it with your own free Apple ID. In Terminal:

```
open ios/gymbro.xcworkspace
```

Xcode opens. Then:

- 1 Menu bar → **Xcode** → **Settings** (or Preferences) → **Accounts** tab.
- 2 Click the **+** in the bottom-left → **Apple ID** → sign in. Close Settings.
- 3 In the left sidebar, click the blue **gymbro** icon at the very top.
- 4 In the middle of the window, click the **Signing & Capabilities** tab.
- 5 Tick **Automatically manage signing**, and under **Team** choose your own name ("Personal Team").
- 6 If a red error says the bundle identifier is **"not available"**: click in the **Bundle Identifier** box just above and change it to something personal, e.g. `com.yourfirstname.gymbro`. The error disappears.

8. Put gymbro on your iPhone

8.1 Prepare the phone (one time)

- 1 Plug the iPhone into the Mac with the cable and **unlock it**.
- 2 If the phone shows **"Trust This Computer?"** → tap **Trust**, enter your passcode.

- 3 On the phone: **Settings** → **Privacy & Security** → scroll to the very bottom → **Developer Mode** → turn it **On** → the phone restarts → unlock it and confirm.

Note: Can't find Developer Mode? It sometimes only appears AFTER the first install attempt. Do step 8.2 once, let it fail, then check Settings again — it will be there.

8.2 Install

- 1 In Xcode, look at the toolbar at the top. Next to the play button there is a device menu — click it and choose **your iPhone** (it's listed by name, above the simulators).
- 2 Press the **■ (play) button** in the top-left.
- 3 The first build takes 5–10 minutes. When it finishes, **gymbro appears on your iPhone**.
- 4 First open only: if the phone says "**Untrusted Developer**" → on the phone go to **Settings** → **General** → **VPN & Device Management** → tap your Apple ID → **Trust**. Open the app again.

That's it. The app greets you with a short welcome tour, and small green cards explain each feature the first time you reach it.

9. The 7-day rule (read this!)

Apps signed with a free Apple ID stop opening after **7 days**. This is an Apple restriction, not a bug. When gymbro suddenly won't open:

- 1 Plug the iPhone into the Mac and unlock it.
- 2 Open Xcode (your project reopens via **File** → **Recent**), make sure your iPhone is selected in the device menu, and press **■** again.

Two minutes, and the app runs for another 7 days. **Your workouts, meals, and settings are never lost** — reinstalling on top keeps all data.

10. Optional: let everyone refresh it themselves

Right now, only the Mac that has Xcode set up (yours, from sections 1–8) can refresh gymbro every 7 days. If friends installed it from your Mac too, they need **you** every week. There's a free, no-Mac-needed alternative — **AltStore** — where each friend does a short one-time setup on their own computer (Windows or Mac) and their phone then refreshes itself automatically, forever. Full step-by-step in **SETUP-WINDOWS.pdf** (also in github.com/gagangeet2517-arch/gymbro) — despite the name, it works for anyone, not just Windows users.

11. Turn on the AI features (optional, free)

Photo food scanning and the nutrition coach use Google Gemini and need a free key:

- 1 On any device, go to aistudio.google.com/apikey, sign in with a Google account, click **Create API key**, and copy it.
- 2 In gymbro: **Home tab** → **Profile** → **AI features · Gemini key** → paste → **Save profile**.
- 3 The status line says "**Using your key**" — done. The key never leaves your phone.

12. Quick tour — what the app can do

- **Workouts tab** — start from a ready-made plan; your weights and reps from last time are pre-filled so you just try to beat them. Add/remove exercises mid-workout; a warm-up and cool-down checklist is generated for every session.
- **Guide me** — a coach mode that walks you through one set at a time with a rest timer.
- **Voice logging** — tap the mic and say "sixty by eight"; the set logs itself. Works offline, costs nothing.
- **Nutrition tab** — photograph your plate or scan a barcode; the AI counts calories and protein. Late-night meals ask whether they belong to yesterday or today.
- **Progress tab** — bodyweight, body fat %, and strength charts fill in automatically, with research-based insights (plateaus, volume spikes, neglected muscles).
- **Profile (Home tab)** — pick a training goal (it tunes plans and calorie targets), habit goals, and daily / long-term reminders with your own message.

Note: The app explains itself as you go: the first time you reach a feature, a small dismissible card describes it. It shows once and disappears after you use the feature or tap ✕.

13. When something goes wrong

13.1 Terminal says "command not found: npm" (or brew, or npx)

The tool from section 4 isn't installed or Terminal hasn't noticed it yet. Close Terminal completely (■Q), reopen it, try again. Still failing → redo the relevant part of section 4.

13.2 Terminal says "permission denied" or "no such file or directory"

Almost always a path problem. Use the drag-trick: type `cd` (with a space), drag the gymbro-main folder from Finder into the Terminal window, press Enter. Never run a folder path on its own without `cd` in front.

13.3 Xcode: "bundle identifier not available" / signing errors

Section 7, last step — change the Bundle Identifier to `com.yourname.gymbro` and re-pick your Team.

13.4 Xcode can't see my iPhone

- Unlock the phone and keep it unlocked; check the cable is properly in.
- Tap **Trust** if the phone asks (again — iOS updates re-ask).
- Check **Developer Mode** is On (section 8.1) — iOS updates sometimes switch it off.
- Still nothing → unplug, replug, wait 30 seconds.

13.5 The app icon suddenly does nothing

The 7-day signature expired — completely normal. Section 9 (or SETUP-WINDOWS.pdf section 4 if you installed via AltStore). Your data is safe.

13.6 "Untrusted Developer" when opening the app

Phone → Settings → General → VPN & Device Management → your Apple ID → Trust.

13.7 AI says a key is missing

Section 11 — add your free Gemini key in Profile.

13.8 Installed via AltStore instead?

AltStore-specific problems (won't install, "maximum app limit reached", refresh not working) are covered in **SETUP-WINDOWS.pdf**, section 6.

14. Where to get help

- Open an issue at github.com/gagangeet2517-arch/gymbro/issues — describe what you clicked and copy the exact error text.
- Google AI Studio (free Gemini keys) — aistudio.google.com
- AltStore / no-Mac install problems — see **SETUP-WINDOWS.pdf**
- Developers who want to modify the app: it's a standard Expo / React Native project — see the README at github.com/gagangeet2517-arch/gymbro.

This PDF is generated from `scripts/make_setup_pdf.py` — edit that file and re-run it to update the guide.